FEBRUARY 2006

Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042
Trudi Tuban - Editor



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

TOUR OF COMPUTER HISTORY MUSEUM
at 1401 N. Shoreline Blvd., Mountain View
SATURDAY -- February 4, 2006 at 2:30 pm

Note: This is a change of meeting date and time

John Toole, Executive Director and CEO of the Computer History Museum, has extended an invitation to MVHA members to tour the museum. The museum was moved from Moffett Field in 2002 after acquiring the Silicon Graphics (SGI) property on North Shoreline Boulevard between L'Avenida Avenue and Pear Avenue. The 120,000 sq. ft. building arrangement and exhibits are being developed in stages. Docent led tours of the visible storage and exhibit areas will be featured. We will be able to socialize together after the tour.

Directions to the Museum: From Freeway 101, take the N. Shoreline exit. From downtown, take Shoreline and go over Freeway 101. Shortly after passing L'Avenida, enter the driveway from N. Shoreline into the Computer Museum parking lot; or turn on to Pear Avenue and then into the parking lot. The tour entrance is noted on a sign as you enter the parking lot.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE BY NICK GALIOTTO

Here we are at the end of the first month of the new year -- already. Your Executive Committee met on January 4 to plan the special gathering of our members on SATURDAY, February 4, at the Computer History Museum. There are many facets to Mountain View's history and certainly the development of the computer industry is a very significant one.

Along these lines, and on behalf of the MVHA, Wally Erichsen is working on a program with the Computer History Museum that will commemorate the contribution of the Shockley Labs of Mountain View to the beginnings of the Silicon Valley we have today. This is an opportunity for our Historical Association to expand its contacts and become more visible within the community.

This leads to our current goal of studying the feasibility of establishing a Heritage Orchard and History Museum in the Cuesta Park Annex. Wally reports that his ad hoc committee, consisting of Wally, Anne Bakotich, Al Jehning, Barbara Kinchen, Vivian Schatz, John Viscovich and Bob Weaver, has begun a site layout of these potential utilizations that will be submitted to the City during its master planning process.

Obviously, if these concepts prove viable, there will need to be strong support to make it happen. Our members provided such support in achieving the preservation of the Adobe Building. Maybe we can be the catalyst once again.

IMPORTANT: Encourage your friends to attend our meetings. They will learn of Mountain View's colorful past and mingle with some of those that have lived it. That's what we're about. See you on SATURDAY, February 4th!!

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS COMPILED BY BARBARA KINCHEN

100 YEARS AGO (1906): Mountain View now has a night watchman. The downtown merchants pay most of his salary and the town the rest.

National Ice Company is building an ice house on the railroad track "below the depot."

Methodists are putting in a cement sidewalk in front of the church property in the 400 block of Castro Street. Reverend Orr raised the $100 cost by "soliciting" downtown businesses.

Frank L. Huff, principal of the elementary school, and Mountain View native, has been awarded a state grammar school certificate for life.

75 YEARS AGO (1931): Perry Askam, star of the operetta THE DESERT SONG, is visiting his Aunt, Mrs. Elise (Rengstorff) Haag of Stierlin Road.

A new mortuary was built for George Beardslee at the corner of Castro Street and Yosemite Avenue. Total cost for land, buildings and ambulance is approximately $25,000.00 (purchased by Martin J. Spangler in 1934).

City Council ordered that all stones, monuments and markers in the Mountain View Cemetery (now Pioneer Park) be buried flat, two feet under the surface of the ground. A record will be made of the location of each marker and a photo taken of each.

Congress has authorized acceptance of 1,000 acres of Mountain View for a Navy dirigible base.

Mountain View Theatre:

Show times: Daily, 7 pm and 9 pm
Sunday, 4 shows, 2:30 pm - 11 pm

Admission: 4-10 years……10 cents
10-12 years…..15 cents
Adults…….....35 cents
Loges……..50 cents

50 YEARS AGO (1956): Plans for extending Bailey Avenue across El Camino to connect with Miramonte Avenue have been approved.

Foster's Old Fashioned Freeze featured six hamburgers for $1.00.

Winter storms (1955-56) and record high tides caused levee breaks which marooned the sewage treatment plant at the end of Stierlin Road.

A blimp has landed at Moffett Field for repairs; the first since the base was changed from lighter-than-air to airplanes in 1947.

25 YEARS AGO (1981): The average interest return on invested city money was 11.8%.

The I.E.D. building at Castro and Mercy Streets has been renamed Mountain Bay Plaza, but is not yet occupied because the available parking spaces do not meet city requirements.

Because of the Mediterranean Fruit Fly, residents were ordered to strip all fruit from trees and then place the fruit in plastic bags for pick-up by the City.

Sherman McCormick, real estate agent and appraiser and former property agent for the City, was named "Citizen of the Year" by the Chamber of Commerce.

New Fans with motors that produce 135,000 horsepower have been installed in the world's biggest wind tunnel at NASA Ames Research Center.

Grand Central Sauna and Hot Tubs, 170 El Camino Real East is the only business of its kind in Santa Clara County. It has 26 rooms which rent for $6.00 per person per hour after 5 pm and $4.75 before 5. Each room is equipped with sauna, shower, four-person hot tub, a bed and security system. Prohibited are liquor, picnics and any one under 18 years of age.

STREET TALK BY *BARBARA KINCHEN*

College, University, Stanford and Leland are streets in the Castro City area, just south of the railroad tracks at Rengstorff Avenue. This was once known as University Park, developed to attract professors from Stanford and perhaps others from San Francisco. The small lots were meant for summer or vacation homes.

NEW QUESTION

In what part of Mountain View are Wild Cherry Lane and Blossom Lane?

NOTE: Do you know that no one has ever come back to us with the answers asked in NEW QUESTION? Feel free to write your answer and send to our PO Box or email the editor at Trudi@tubanonline.org.

NEW TO THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORY CENTER

From member Mrs. Ruth (Job) Erichsen: Eight small jewelry pins, several identified as from Mountain View High School. These belonged to Ruth's Aunts, Martha Job, a 1911 graduate and Lyle Job, a 1930 graduate.

EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE REPORT

The Mountain View Historical Association Executive Committee met on January 4, 2006. Discussions were held concerning new donations to the History Room, the activities of the History Museum Committee, an audit report of history MV books sold and the up-coming tour of the computer history museum.

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND EXECUTIVE OFFICERS

President	Nick Galiotto
Vice President	Vivian Schatz
Sergeant at Arms	JohnViscovich
Secretary	Margaret Peterson
Treasurer	Pat Figueroa
Past President	Craig Holden
Editor	Trudi Tuban
Membership	June Casey
Memorials & Remembrances	Edna Thompson
Programs & Publicity	Wally Erichsen
Hospitality	Dorothy Rich
Ways & Means	Hip Telmont
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification & Recording	Al Jehning

INCOME AND EXPENSE STATEMENT

Ending Balance as of September 6, 2005: $35,071.81
Income: $2,204.41
Expenses: $ 300.00

MEMBERSHIP REPORT BY JUNE CASEY

Life Members	121
Honored Member	1
Family Membership	128
Single Membership	105
TOTAL	355

New A/S members: Wanda L. Beck, Kathryn (Volarvich) Gemello, Christopher Rezendes
New A/F members: Ernest H. and Ann (Renner) Gamma

IN MEMORIAM

MARIO GEMELLO: **Passed away at home in Los Altos on October 31, 2005. Mario was born September 27, 1916 in Cupertino. He graduated from Mountain View High School in 1934. He is survived by his wife of 64 years, Kathryn Volarvich Gemello; daughter, Patricia Ferguson of Belmont; son, John Gemello of San Mateo; son, Mark Gemello of San Jose; his sister, Celestine Traverso of Mountain View; six grandchildren and one great-grandchild.**

Mario's family originally had 35 acres of vegetables, fruit and a homestead that was between Rengstorff and El Monte on the West side of El Camino Real. Quite a few acres were sold during prohibition, but in 1934, the family started the Gemello Winery at 2003 El Camino Real (next to Bob's Big Boy and behind a bowling alley and a small shopping center). Upon his father's retirement in 1944, Mario took over full control of the winery. Mario retired in 1982 and the award-winning Gemello wine label retired with him. The winery was sold to his niece and husband, Sandy and Paul Obester, who had their own winery under their own name in Half Moon Bay.

Mario was a member of the St. Francis High School Men's Club, the Elks Club of Palo Alto and St. Joseph's parish. He served as president of the Eagles of Mountain View, the Santa Clara Valley Wine-growers Association and the Kiwanis Club. He was a member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

Mountain View Historical Association

SPECIAL GATHERING

TOUR OF THE COMPUTER HISTORY MUSEUM
1401 N. SHORELINE BLVD MOUNTAIN VIEW

--SATURDAY--
February 4 @ 2:30pm

NOTE DATE & TIME

Membership: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

Aims: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME:

ADDRESS:

TELEPHONE:

TYPE: NEW_____ RENEWAL_____
Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

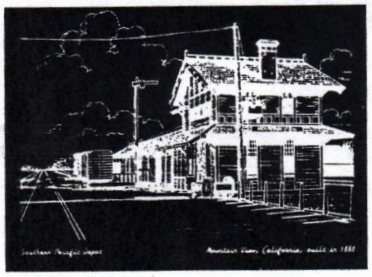
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